

PCF 7.5 — Reward-to-Retain Value Stream

HITL Design

This document defines the HITL (Human-in-the-Loop) design for the Reward-to-Retain value stream, spanning APQC PCF v8.0 process group 7.5 (Reward and Retain Employees) — 5 Level 3 processes and 15 Level 4 activities in total.

At M3 (HITL Design Intent), this value stream's aggregate human-involvement ratio is 47%, down from a 71% undesigned (M1) baseline — a 24-point AI convergence opportunity. Role accountability for every L3 process is confirmed under the framework's reasoned-match methodology, grounded in real APQC L4 activity text against the Organizational Role Taxonomy's documented responsibilities.

HITL Impact Analysis

Human involvement (H%) at M1 (Undesigned) and M3 (HITL Design Intent), by L3 process. Mixed-pattern L3 rows reflect an equal-weighted rollup of their real L4 children.

Process Step (L3)	PCF	Pattern	M1 H%	M3 H%	Δ M1 → M3	Opportunity
Develop and Manage Reward, Recognition, and Motivation Programs	7.5.1	Mixed	79%	58%	-21%	Administration and reward-delivery activities (Transaction-pattern) carry the clearest AI-absorption opportunity; compensation structure design and the recurring plan-review cadence stay Knowledge-pattern and human-led.
Manage and Administer Benefits	7.5.2	Transaction	60%	35%	-25%	Fully Transaction-pattern — enrollment, claims processing, and reconciliation — the most automatable content in this value stream, consistent with its purely operational scope.
Manage Employee Assistance and Retention	7.5.3	Knowledge	85%	65%	-20%	Entirely Knowledge-pattern; work/life balance program delivery and family-support system design stay human-led, with the smallest Δ M1 → M3 among this value stream's real L4 breakdowns.
Administer Payroll	7.5.4	Transaction	60%	35%	-25%	HR's scope here is limited to personnel-data integrity feeding payroll, not the payroll run itself — Finance owns that portion outside this value stream's accountability boundary.
Manage/Collect Employee Suggestions and Research	7.5.5	Document	72%	40%	-32%	The steepest AI-absorption opportunity in this value stream — survey and suggestion-program administration is Document-pattern content well suited to AI-assisted synthesis.

AI Capability Map

Pattern-type distribution across all 17 activity units in this value stream (15 L4 activities plus two single-leaf L3s). H% figures are the pattern type's standard value at each maturity level, applied consistently across all PCF domains.

DECISION <i>Judgment & Authority — gates that stay human by design</i> 0 L4 activities <i>No activities of this pattern in this value stream</i>	KNOWLEDGE <i>Synthesis & Interpretation — judgment-driven work</i> 9 L4 activities M1 85% → M3 65%
DOCUMENT <i>Content Generation — drafting and communication</i> 1 L4 activities M1 72% → M3 40%	TRANSACTION <i>Rules-Based Processing — suited to automation</i> 7 L4 activities M1 60% → M3 35%
EXCEPTION <i>Non-Standard Resolution — human-resolved by nature</i> 0 L4 activities <i>No activities of this pattern in this value stream</i>	

PCF 7.5 — Reward-to-Retain Value Stream

HITL Design

Role Accountability

Confirmed RACI assignment for every L3 process, reasoned-match methodology. Full assignment reasoning is documented in the companion Role Assignment RACI document for this value stream.

PCF	L3 Process	R	A	C	I
7.5.1	Develop/Manage Reward, Recognition, Motivation Programs	Compensation Analyst (admin-tier activities)	Compensation & Benefits Manager	—	HRBP Manager
7.5.2	Manage and Administer Benefits	—	Compensation Analyst	Compensation & Benefits Manager	HRIS Analyst
7.5.3	Manage Employee Assistance and Retention	—	HR Generalist	HRBP Manager	Director of HR Ops
7.5.4	Administer Payroll	—	HRIS Analyst (HR-owned scope)	Compensation Analyst	Finance*
7.5.5	Manage/Collect Employee Suggestions and Research	HRIS Analyst (data/survey tooling)	HR Generalist	—	HRBP Manager

*Finance owns the payroll run and payroll accounting portions of Administer Payroll, outside HR's accountability scope for this L3 — logged as an external participant.

Design Narrative

Reward-to-Retain has no Decision-pattern activity and no Executive-tier accountability anywhere in this value stream — human judgment here is concentrated in Knowledge-pattern program design and review work (7.5.1's compensation-structure design and recurring plan-review cadence, 7.5.3's work/life balance and family-support program delivery) rather than in formal approval gates. The value stream also introduces its first genuine cross-functional accountability boundary: 7.5.4 Administer Payroll is Accountable to HRIS Analyst but explicitly scoped to HR-owned personnel data, with Finance owning the payroll run itself as an external participant. The steepest AI-absorption opportunity sits in 7.5.5 (Manage/Collect Employee Suggestions and Research, Document-pattern, -32 points), the value stream's only Document-pattern content.

For governance and compliance oversight context spanning this value stream, see the Enable & Govern HITL Design and Process Specification documents (PCF 7.4, 7.7, 7.8).